

PHP MASTERY CHECKLIST

(Core PHP – Real-World Readiness)

Student Name: _____

Instructor Name: _____

BASIC LEVEL — PHP FOUNDATIONS

(Goal: Understand core PHP syntax and request handling)

[] - PHP Introduction & Setup

Able to explain what PHP is, how it runs on a server, and set up XAMPP/WAMP.

[] - PHP Syntax & Structure

Can write PHP tags, echo/print output, and understand PHP execution flow.

[] - Variables & Data Types

Can use strings, integers, floats, booleans, and understand type behavior.

[] - Operators

Can use arithmetic, assignment, comparison, logical, and concatenation operators.

[] - Conditional Statements

Can write if, else, elseif, and switch statements to control logic.

[] - Loops

Can use for, while, do-while, and foreach loops correctly.

[] - Arrays (Indexed, Associative, Multidimensional)

Can store, access, loop through, and manipulate arrays.

[] - Array Functions

Can use count, array_push, array_merge, in_array, explode, implode.

[] - String Handling

Can use strlen, strpos, substr, trim, strtoupper, strtolower.

[] - GET & POST Methods

Understands form submission and data retrieval securely.

[] - HTML Forms with PHP

Can create forms and handle input using PHP.

INTERMEDIATE LEVEL — WORKING WITH DATA & STATE

(Goal: Build dynamic, data-driven applications)

[] - Functions (User-Defined)

Can create reusable functions with parameters and return values.

[] - Include & Require

Can reuse headers, footers, and configuration files.

[] - File Handling

Can read/write files, upload files, validate file type and size.

[] - Cookies

Understands how cookies work, can set, read, and delete cookies.

[] - Sessions

Can start sessions, store user data, and protect pages.

[] - HTTP & Stateless Concept

Understands why sessions/cookies are needed in PHP.

[] - MySQL Basics

Understands databases, tables, primary keys, and relationships.

[] - Database Connection (PDO)

Can connect PHP with MySQL using PDO.

[] - PDO Prepared Statements

Can prepare, bind, and execute queries securely.

[] - Insert Data into Database

Can insert form data into MySQL using PDO.

[] - Fetch & Display Data

Can retrieve data and display it in tables or lists.

[] - Update Records

Can edit existing records using forms and PDO.

[] - Delete Records

Can delete records safely with confirmation.

ADVANCED LEVEL — SECURITY & REAL-WORLD PRACTICE

(Goal: Write secure, professional PHP code)

[] - **CRUD Operations (Complete)**

Can build full Create, Read, Update, Delete functionality.

[] - **Form Validation**

Can validate required fields, email formats, and input length.

[] - **Password Hashing**

Can hash passwords and verify them securely.

[] - **Authentication System**

Can build login/logout system using sessions.

[] - **Authorization Basics**

Can restrict pages based on login status or role.

[] - **SQL Injection Prevention**

Fully understands prepared statements and why they are required.

[] - **XSS Basics**

Can sanitize output to prevent script injection.

[] - **CSRF Awareness**

Understands CSRF concept and basic protection idea.

[] - **File Upload Security**

Can validate file extensions and prevent malicious uploads.

[] - **Pagination & Search**

Can implement basic search and pagination logic.

[] - **Code Reusability**

Can reuse logic instead of rewriting the same code.

[] - **Project Folder Structure**

Can organize files professionally (includes, assets, pages).

PROJECT COMPLETION CHECK

(Real-World Readiness)

- ☐ - Login System Project
 - ☐ - CRUD Admin Panel
 - ☐ - File Upload Project
 - ☐ - Database-Driven Application
 - ☐ - One Complete Final Project (School / E-commerce / Quiz)
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INSTRUCTOR EVALUATION NOTES

COURSE COMPLETION STATEMENT

By completing all items above, the student has demonstrated the ability to build real-world PHP applications using secure coding practices and database-driven logic.

Student Signature: _____

Date: _____